

Static GK Test -18

Q1. _____ is a lively dance form of the Bundelkhand region. Its performance begins with the beating of mridang and gradually gains momentum dotted with prose and poetic dialogues.

- A) Matki
- B) Gangaur
- C) Rai
- D) Swang**

Solution: 1.(d) Swang - A popular folk dance - theatre form performed in Rajasthan, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh and Malwa region of Madhya Pradesh. Other dances: Rai - This dance of Bundelkhand is performed by a man disguised as a woman to the accompaniment of musical instruments like dholak and nagara. Matki - A community dance from the Malwa region, performed by women. Gangaur - Performed during the nine days of Gangaur festival in the Nimar region in honour of their deity Ranubai and Dhaniyer Suryadev.

Q2. First edition of the Youth Olympic Games was held at _____.

- A) Lausanne
- B) Singapore**
- C) Nanjing
- D) Innsbruck

Solution: 11.(b) First edition (2010) of the Youth Olympic Games was held in Singapore. Tag line: blazing the trail. 2018 youth olympic games : Host city (Buenos Aires, Argentina), Winner (China). 2014- Nanjing (China), 2026- Dakar (Senegal).

Q3. International Non-Violence Day is observed on:

- A) 15 August
- B) 31 October
- C) 2 October**
- D) 14 November

Solution: 5.(c) International day of Non-violence has been observed every year on 2nd October (the birthday of Mahatma Gandhi) since 2007. 2021 theme: 'Recovering better for an equitable and sustainable world'. 31st October (National Unity Day, birth anniversary of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel).

Q4. 'Wings' is associated with which of the following sports events?

- A) Paralympic 2020**
- B) Olympic 2016
- C) Olympic 2020
- D) Winter Olympic 2020

Solution: 4.(a) Paralympic 2020. The first-ever Paralympics Games was held in 1960. Although the ancient Games were staged in Olympia, Greece, from 776 BC. The first modern Olympics were held in Athens, Greece, in 1896. Baron Pierre de Coubertin was the founder of the modern Olympic Games.

Q5. "Mysuru Dasara" is a grand celebration in the Indian state of _____ featuring a royal procession, cultural events, and a display of decorated elephants.

- A) Kerala
- B) Karnataka**
- C) Orissa
- D) Tamil Nadu

Solution: 4.(b) Karnataka. Mysore Dasara is a 10-day festival, starting with nine nights called Navratri and the last day being Vijayadashami. The festival is observed on the tenth day in the Hindu calendar month of Ashvina. Important festivals celebrated in Indian states: Karnataka - Gombi Habba, Gowri Habba. Kerala - Onam, Vishu (Malayalam New Year), Vettukad Festival. Orissa - Raja Festival, Nua Khai Festival, Dhanu Yatra; Tamil Nadu - Mahamagam, Chithirai, Arubathu Moovar Festival.

Q6. Rabindra Sangeet is associated with:

- A) Rabi
- B) Ravindra Jain
- C) Rabindranath Tagore**

D) Ravi Shankar

Solution: 4.(c) Rabindranath Tagore. Rabindra Sangeet is a set of folk songs sung during festivals and rituals in West Bengal. Other Folk songs in West Bengal : Bhatiali, baul. Rabindranath Tagore's Achievements - Nobel Prize for Literature (1913) for his poetry collection Gitanjali, 'Amar Sonar Bangla', the national anthem of Bangladesh was composed by Rabindranath Tagore in 1905, Awarded Knighthood for Services to Literature by King George V in 1915 but returned the title in 1919 to protest against the Jallianwala Bagh massacre.

Q7. When a shuttle is fired high into the air, the player has time to make a powerful overhead shot (overhand shot) directly on the opposing court's command. It is known as _____.

- A) Long service
- B) Rally
- C) Short service
- D) Smash**

Solution: 3.(d) Smash is a shot that is hit above the hitter's head with a serve-like motion in tennis. Some terms used in tennis: Ace, Backhand, Volley, Forehand, Advantage, Fault, Break point, Doubles, Drop shot. Grand Slam: Australian Open: Started in 1905, French Open: Started in 1891, Wimbledon: Started in 1877, US Open: Started in 1881.

Q8. Nati is the folk dance of which of the following Indian states ?

- A) Jharkhand
- B) Arunachal Pradesh
- C) Gujarat
- D) Himachal Pradesh**

Solution: 3.(d) Himachal Pradesh. Nati dance : It is performed by a group of people with accompanying musicians. Both men and women participate in the dance. The Kullu district administration set a Guinness World Record for the largest Nati dance on 26 October 2015 With 9,892 dancers. Classical dances : Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu), Kathak (Uttar Pradesh), Kathakali (Kerala), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Manipuri (Manipur), Mohiniyattam (Kerala), Odissi (Odisha), Sattriya (Assam).

Q9. 'Mundari' dance is associated with which of the following state ?

- A) Kerala
- B) Jharkhand**
- C) Uttar Pradesh
- D) Tamil Nadu

Solution: 9.(b) Jharkhand has various traditional dance forms, including Mardani Jhumar, Paika, Chhau, Santhal Dance, Agni Dance, Phagua, Nachni. Other states and dances: Kerala - Kathakali, Mohiniyattam, Theyyam, Koothu. Uttar Pradesh - Kathak, Ramlila, Braj Raslila, Charkula, Rasiya. Tamil Nadu - Bharatanatyam, Karakattam, Mayil Attam, Kummi, Theru Koothu.

Q10. Which of the following sports is played by Siddharth Suchde ?

- A) Football
- B) Badminton
- C) Tennis
- D) Squash**

Solution: 11.(d) Squash. It is played by two players for singles matches or four players for doubles matches. Other Players: Squash - Saurav Ghosal, Dipika Pallikal, Anahat Singh. Football - Sunil Chhetri, Gurpreet Singh Sandhu. Badminton - Pullela Gopichand, Saina Nehwal, PV Sindhu. Tennis - Sania Mirza, Rohan Bopanna.

Q11. Which of the following states recognise the Dahi Handi as a sports event?

- A) Maharashtra**
- B) Bihar
- C) Madhya Pradesh
- D) Uttar Pradesh

Solution: 13.(a) Maharashtra. Dahi Handi (Gopal kala) is celebrated during the Krishna Janmashtami. Other festivals : Maharashtra - Ganesh Chaturthi, Gudi Padwa or Chaitra Pratipada, Narali Purnima. Bihar - Chhath Puja, Pitrapaksha Mela, Bihula. Madhya Pradesh - Lokrang Festival, Khajuraho Festival, Bhagoria Haat Festival, Malwa Utsav. Uttar Pradesh - Ganga Dussehra, Lathmar Holi, Taj Mahotsav.

Q12. Match the following neighboring countries of India with their official languages.

- A) 1-a, 2-c, 3-b
- B) 1-a, 2-b, 3-c
- C) 1-c, 2-a, 3-b**
- D) 1-b, 2-a, 3-c

Solution: 5.(c) 1-c, 2-a, 3-b. Countries and their Language: Laos - Lao, Thailand - Thai, Afghanistan- Dari/Pashto, Cambodia - Khmer, Iran - Persian, Maldives - Dhivehi, Pakistan - Urdu, Yemen, Lebanon, UAE - Arabic, Israel - Hebrew.

Q13. Ustad Bismillah Khan is a famous exponent of _____.

- A) dholak
- B) shehnai**
- C) tabla
- D) harmonium

Solution: 13.(b) Shehnai. Ustad Bismillah Khan was awarded the Bharat Ratna in 2001, the Padma Vibhushan in 1980, and the Padma Bhushan in 1968. Musical Instruments and Exponents: Shehnai - Pt. Raghunath Prasanna, Krishna Ram Chaudhary, Ali Ahmad Hussain; Tabla - Ustad Ahmed Jan Thirakwa, Pt. Samta Prasad; Harmonium - Appa Jalgaonkar, Tulsidas Vasant Borkar.

Q14. Who among the following is known as 'Sarod Samrat' in Indian Classical Music?

- A) Pandit Ravishankar Prasad
- B) Aamir Ali Khan
- C) Amjad Ali Khan**
- D) Kishan Maharaj

Solution: 7.(c) Ustad Amjad Ali Khan also known as Sarod Samrat is a famous Sarod player. He was awarded Padma Shri (1975), Padma Bhushan (1991), Padma Vibhushan (2001), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1989), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (2011) and Fukuoka Asian Culture Prize (2004). Pandit Ravishankar (Sitarist), Aamar Ali khan (Indian Actor), Pandit Kishan Maharaj (Tabla player).

Q15. What are the events in power lifting ?

- A) Squats, bench press and dead lift**
- B) Squats, lat pull down and curl
- C) Curls, bench press and squat
- D) Curls, over arm lift and dead lift

Solution: 1.(a) Squats, bench press and deadlift. Other events related to Sports: Swimming - Freestyle, Butterfly, Backstroke. Athletics - Relay, Hurdles, Shot Put, High Jump. Cycling - Sprint, Time trial, Track race, Point race. Shooting - Rapidfire Pistol, Standard rifle, Free pistol, Air rifle, Range, Bull's eye. Weight Lifting - Jerk, Snatch.

Q16. Kalbelia dance is generally performed in which of the following states of India?

- A) Tamil Nadu
- B) Punjab
- C) Rajasthan**
- D) Assam

Solution: 10.(c) Rajasthan. Kalbelia Dance (Sapera Dance) is performed by women while males play various traditional instruments. It was included in the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organizations (UNESCO) list of Intangible Cultural Heritage (ICH) in 2010. Other Dance - Ghoomar, Bhawai, Kachhi Ghodi, Chari. Tamil Nadu - Bharatanatyam (Classical dance), Karakattam, Pulliyattam. Punjab - Bhangra, Giddha, Luddi, Gatka. Assam - Bagurumba Dance, Sattriya Dance (Classical dance), Deodhani, Ali-Ai-Ligang (Mishing tribe).

Q17. Which of the following festival has 'Jalli Kattu' as a feature ?

- A) Onam
- B) Vishu
- C) Bihu
- D) Pongal**

Solution: 7.(d) Pongal. It is a harvest festival celebrated by the Tamil community. Jallikattu is a traditional sport of Tamil Nadu that is celebrated on the third day of Pongal – Mattu Pongal Day. Other festivals of Tamil Nadu: Karthigai Deepam, Vinayaka Chaturthi, Puthandu.

Q18. In which sport the Participants are called Pugilist ?

- A) Badminton
- B) Hockey
- C) Boxing**
- D) Tennis

Solution: 14.(c) Boxing. Pugilist is a historical term originated from the Latin word "pugil" which means a fist-fighter or boxer. Boxing terminologies: Clinch, Eight count, Jab, Knockdown, Second, Shoulder roll, Southpaw, Toe-to-toe.

Q19. Which instrument is played by Amjad Ali Khan ?

- A) Sarod**
- B) Sitar
- C) Santoor
- D) Guitar

Solution: 15.(a) Sarod. He was honored with the Padma Vibhushan in 2001, the Padma Bhushan in 1991, and the Padma Shri in 1975. Musical instruments and their exponents: Sarod - Allauddin Khan, Sharan Rani Backliwal, and Zarin S. Sharma; Sitar - Ustad Vilayat Khan, Pt. Ravi Shankar, and Shahid Parvez Khan; Santoor - Bhajan Sopori, Pt. Shiv Kumar Sharma, and Pt. Tarun Bhattacharya; Guitar - Braj Bhushan Kabra.

Q20. Maximum how many overs can a bowler bowl in ODI cricket matches?

- A) 11
- B) 9
- C) 10**
- D) 8

Solution: 2.(c) 10. The minimum number of bowlers in a 50 over ODI match has to be 5. The maximum number of overs per bowler in T20 Cricket is 4. Breaks between sessions (test cricket match) - 40 minutes for Lunch, and 20 minutes for Tea. The first ODI was played on 5 January 1971 between Australia and England at the Melbourne Cricket Ground.

Q21. Duleep Trophy is associated with _____.

- A) badminton
- B) cricket**
- C) football
- D) basketball

Solution: 12.(b) Cricket. The Duleep Trophy is a domestic first-class cricket competition played in India. The first edition was held in 1961-62 and was named after the former cricketer Duleepsinhji. Other trophies related to cricket include the C.K. Naidu Trophy, Rani Jhansi Trophy, Deodhar Trophy, Ranji Trophy, Vijay Hazare Trophy, Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy and Moin-ud-Dowlah Gold Cup.

Q22. Pandit Birju Maharaj is associated with which form of dance?

- A) Kathak**
- B) Chhau
- C) Kuchipudi
- D) Kathakali

Solution: 6.(a) Kathak. Birju Maharaj was a prominent figure in the Lucknow "Kalka-Bindadin" Gharana of Kathak dance in India. Awards:- Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1964), Padma Vibhushan (1986), Kalidas Samman (1987), Lata Mangeshkar Puraskar (2002), and National Film Award (2012) for Best Choreography for Unnai Kaanaathu. Exponents (Kathak): Shambhu Maharaj, Birju Maharaj, Sitara Devi, Sunder Prasad, Lacchu Maharaj.

Q23. Who among the following advocated the ideology of "oru jati, oru matam, oru daivam manushyanu" (one caste, one religion, one god for humankind)?

- A) Birsa Munda
- B) Narayana Guru**
- C) Swami Shradhanand
- D) Keshub Chunder Sen

Solution: 14.(b) Narayana Guru. He belongs to Ezhava caste and was considered 'avarna'. He built a temple dedicated to Lord Shiva at Aruvippuram which was against the caste based restrictions of the time. He established the Sree Narayana Dharma Paripalana Yogam (SNDP), a charitable society. His Books: "Advaita Deepika", "Asrama" and "Thevarappathinkangal". He became the proponent of Advaita Vedanta (Principle of non-duality) put forward by Adi Shankara.

Q24. Pool swimming at the Olympic Games takes place inside a _____ meter-long swimming pool divided into eight lanes.

- A) 75
- B) 50**
- C) 100
- D) 25

Solution: 5.(b) 50. The modern Olympic Games are the world's leading international sporting events. Games: Summer, Winter, Youth. Regional games: Asian, African, European, Pacific, Pan-American. Paris Olympic 2024: Location - Paris (France), Motto - "Games Wide Open", Opened by - President Emmanuel Macron.

Q25. Which sport features the "Breaststroke" as a technique ?

- A) Horse riding
- B) Pool
- C) Swimming**
- D) Shooting

Solution: 9.(c) Swimming. It has been an Olympic sport since the first modern Olympic Games in 1896. Breaststroke is done with the chest forward and facing towards the bottom of the pool, and not rotating the torso. Other types of swimming strokes: freestyle, backstroke, and butterfly.

Q26. The railway system connecting St - Petersburg to Vladivostok is _____.

- A) The Altai Railway
- B) The Amur Railways
- C) Trans - Baikal Railway
- D) Trans - Siberian Railways**

Solution: 14.(d) The Trans-Siberian Railway is the longest railway system connecting St. Petersburg in Western Russia to Vladivostok on the Pacific coast. India's Longest (Vivek Express - Dibrugarh to Kanyakumari-4273 km). The Trans-Baikal Railway is a subsidiary of the Russian Railways headquartered in Chita and serving Zabaykalsky Krai and Amur Oblast. Amur Railway is the last section of the Trans-Siberian Railway in Russia, built in 1907–1916.

Q27. What theme was decided to celebrate the second 'International Day of Yoga' in India?

- A) Yoga for the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals**
- B) Yoga for Peace
- C) Yoga for Wellness
- D) Yoga for Heart

Solution: 3.(a) International day of Yoga is celebrated every year since 21 June 2015. Themes: 2015 ("Yoga for Harmony and Peace"), 2016 ('Yoga for the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals'), 2017 ('Yoga for Health'), 2018 ('Yoga for Peace. '), 2019 ("Yoga for Heart"), 2020 ("Yoga for Health - Yoga at Home"), 2021 ("Yoga For Wellness"), 2022 ("Yoga for humanity").

Q28. Tansen, who was included in the Navaratnas of Akbar, was an expert in playing which of the following musical instruments?

- A) Nagada
- B) Veena
- C) Sarangi

D) Rabab

Solution: 12.(d) Rabab (String instrument). Tansen (Ramtanu Pandey) - A Hindustani classical musician also Known as Sangeeth Samrat or Mian (Learned One). Tansen Samaroh is celebrated every year in the month of December in Gwalior district. The National Tansen Samman is a musical award conferred to the exponents. Navratna of Akbar - Raja Todar Mal (finance minister), Mullah Do Piazza, Fakir Aziao-Din, Abdul Rahim Khan-I-Khana, Abul Fazl (Wrote Ain-i-Akbari), Raja Birbal, Faizi, Raja Man Singh, Miyan Tansen.

Q29. The activity of making a human pyramid and putting efforts to break an earthen pot filled with buttermilk is associated with which festival?

- A) Holi
- B) Janmashtami**
- C) Dushara
- D) Mahashivaratri

Solution: 15.(b) Janmashtami. It is a Hindu festival celebrating the birth of god Krishna on the eighth (ashtami) day of the dark fortnight of the month of Bhadrapada. Dahi handi is a popular festival in Maharashtra. Famous festivals related to Lord Krishna: Govardhan Puja, Holi. Lord Krishna temples in India:- Jagannath Temple (Puri, Odisha), Dwarkadhish (Gujarat), Guruvayur (Kerala), Udupi Sri Krishna Matha (Karnataka). Temples in Vrindavan (Uttar Pradesh)- Sri Sri Radha Madan Mohan Mandir, Banke Bihari, Jugal Kishore, Radha Raman, Prem Mandir.

Q30. Which of the following is the capital of the People's Republic of China ?

- A) Guangzhou
- B) Beijing**
- C) Hangzhou
- D) Shanghai

Solution: 12.(b) Beijing. Countries and Their Capitals: Afghanistan - Kabul, Argentina - Buenos Aires, Australia - Canberra, Austria - Vienna, Belgium - Brussels, Brazil - Brasilia, Denmark - Copenhagen, Finland - Helsinki, Iran - Tehran.

Q31. Tapan Kumar Pattanayak won the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in which dance form ?

- A) Chhau**
- B) Sattriya
- C) Odissi
- D) Kuchipudi

Solution: 6.(a) Chhau. Tapan Kumar Pattanayak won the Sangeet Natak Akademi (established in 1953) Award in 2018. Chhau is a dance form that combines martial arts, tribal, and folk traditions. Three styles of Chhau : Purulia Chhau (West Bengal), Seraikella Chhau (Jharkhand), and Mayurbhanj Chhau (Odisha). In 2010, UNESCO added Chhau to its Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity.

Q32. Who among the following is the first Indian female football player to play in Union of European Football Association (UEFA)'s women's champions league?

- A) Shanti Mallick
- B) Bala Devi
- C) Manisha Kalyan**
- D) Oinam Bembem Devi

Solution: 9.(c) Manisha Kalyan. She won the 2020–21 AIFF Women's Emerging Footballer of the Year and the 2022–23 AIFF Women's Player of the Year awards. UEFA Women's Champions League (previously, UEFA Women's Cup (2001–2009)) - It is a European women's association football competition. Founded - 2001. It was first played in 2001–02. Shanti Mallick - The first female footballer in India to have been awarded the Arjuna award (1983). Oinam Bembem Devi - Padma Shri (2020), Arjuna Award (2017).

Q33. Which artists have won the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for contribution to Chhau dance of Seraikella ?

- A) Tapan Kumar Pattanayak**
- B) Diwan Sing Bajeli

- C) Narendra Sing Negi
D) Jatin Goswami

Solution: 2.(a) Tapan Kumar Pattanayak. Sangeet Natak Akademi Award is the highest Indian recognition given to people in the field of performing arts. Chhau is a semi classical Indian dance with martial and folk traditions. It is found in three styles i.e., the Purulia Chhau (West Bengal), the Seraikella Chhau (Jharkhand) and the Mayurbhanj Chhau (Odisha).

Q34. Leander Paes is associated with _____.

- A) Badminton
B) Lawn Tennis
C) Cricket
D) Golf

Solution: 2.(b) Lawn Tennis. Leander Paes (Awards) : Padma Bhushan (2014), Padma Shri (2001), Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna award (1996-97) and Arjuna Award (1990). Other Tennis Players: Novak Djokovic, Serena Williams, Roger Federer, Rafael Nadal, Sania Mirza, and Rohan Bopanna. Eminent Badminton players: Saina Nehwal, Lakshya Sen, and P. V. Sindhu. Eminent Cricket Players: Mithali Raj, Smriti Mandhana, and Arshdeep Singh. Eminent Golf Players: Scottie Scheffler, and Steven Mark Bottomley.

Q35. The term 'Back-stick' is used in which of the following games/sports?

- A) Basketball
B) Badminton
C) Hockey
D) Volleyball

Solution: 1.(c) Back stick is a terminology used in the game of hockey which is a penalty for hitting the ball on the rounded back side of the stick. Other terminologies used in the game of hockey:, Bully, Circle, Charging, Channel, Clear, Chip, Crumbs, The "D", Drag flick, Flagrant foul, Flick, Flat-stick tackle, Foot, Green Card, Hacking, Hooking, Indian Dribble, Jink, Leading pass, Yellow Card, Tomahawk, Tackle, Sweep hit, Swatting, Scoop, Red Card, Pitch, etc.

Q36. Which of the following festivals in Punjab is celebrated to commemorate the formation of the Khalsa Panth?

- A) Lohri
B) Hola Mohalla
C) Teej
D) Baisakhi

Solution: 2.(d) Baisakhi (Sikh New Year) commemorates the formation of Khalsa Panth by Guru Gobind Singh in 1699. It is mainly celebrated in the states of Punjab and Haryana. It is a spring harvest festival usually celebrated on 13 or 14 April every year. Lohri (marks the passing of the winter solstice), Hola Mohalla (three-day long Sikh festival which normally falls in March), Teej (also known as Teeyan, dedicated to the onset of the monsoon).

Q37. Which of the following folk dance forms does NOT belong to the state of Gujarat?

- A) Garba
B) Dandiya
C) Bidesiya
D) Vinchhudo

Solution: 12.(c) Bidesiya is a folk dance form of Bihar. Other dance forms of Bihar include jat-jatin, Jumri, Jhijhiya, Kajri, Paika, Sama Chakewa, etc. Gujarat: Garba, Dandiya, Bhavai, Dandiya Raas, Tippi, Padhar, Hoodo, etc.

Q38. Sports Authority of India, the apex body for sports promotion, was set up in the year _____.

- A) 1990
B) 1961
C) 1984
D) 1982

Solution: 3.(c) 1984. Sports Authority of India (SAI): Headquarters - New Delhi. Associated Ministry - Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports. Sports Organization and Headquarters : Board of Control for Cricket in India (Mumbai) - 1928. Indian Olympic Association (New Delhi) - 1927, All India

Football Federation (New Delhi) - 1937. All India Council of Sports (AICS) established in 1950.

Q39. In any tennis game, if both players win three points each in a game (i.e. score is 40-40), then it's called a _____ .

- A) equal
B) deuce
C) back
D) rattle

Solution: 6.(b) Deuce. Tennis scoring system - A player or team has to win 4 points to win a game. Any game starts at 0-0 and the zero point in tennis is called love. The progression of points occurs as follows: First point - 15, Second point - 30, Third point - 40, Fourth point - Game. After deuce, the player who wins the next point has advantage.

Q40. With which of the following states is the folk dance Tarangamel associated ?

- A) Goa**
B) Madhya Pradesh
C) Tamil Nadu
D) Kerala

Solution: 15.(a) "Tarangamel" is the folk dance performed during Dussehra and Holi in the state of Goa. Other folk dances of Goa include Dhalo, Corredinho, Dekhni, Fugdi, Lamp Dance, Dhangar, Dashavatara, Shigmo, Kunbi, Romat, Goff, Mussal, Ghode Modni, etc.

Q41. The National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, now known as Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, was first enacted in the year_____.

- A) 2000
B) 2005
C) 2009
D) 2014

Solution: 10.(b) 2005. Launched by the Ministry of Rural development. The primary objective of the scheme is to guarantee 100 days of employment in every financial year to adult members of any rural household willing to do public work-related unskilled manual work. Wages must be paid under the Minimum Wages Act, 1948. The act was first proposed in 1991 by former Prime Minister P.V. Narasimha Rao.

Q42. Mopin is an agricultural festival celebrated in the state of _____ .

- A) Bihar
B) Arunachal Pradesh
C) West Bengal
D) Himachal Pradesh

Solution: 2.(b) Arunachal Pradesh. Mopin : Festival of the Galo tribe celebrated in April month. Agricultural Festivals in India : Pongal (Tamil Nadu), Baisakhi (Punjab and Haryana), Wangala, Ka Pomblang Nongkrem (Meghalaya), Nuakhai (Orissa), Gudi Padwa (Maharashtra), Onam (Kerala), Ugadi (Andhra Pradesh and Karnataka) etc.

Q43. The length of the playing surface for Table Tennis is _____.

- A) 2.74 m**
B) 3.74 m
C) 4.74 m
D) 5.74 m

Solution: 12.(a) 2.74 m. Dimension - Upper Surface - 274 cm long, 152.5 cm wide, Height from the floor - 76 cm. Table Tennis Terminology - Twiddle, Strike, Stroke, Sweet Spot, Volley, Umpire, Rally, Playing Surface, Looper, Flick or Flip.

Q44. Padma Shri awardee of 2022, Nalini-Kamalini Asthana belongs to which of the following art genres?

- A) Painting
B) Sculpture
C) Kathak dance
D) Architecture

Solution: 5.(c) Kathak dance. Nalini Asthana and Kamalini Asthana are sisters from Agra in Uttar Pradesh known for their great performances of the Benaras Gharana. Awards: Padma Shri (2022). Exponents in Kathak: Pandit Birju Maharaj, Shovna Narayan, Shambhu Maharaj, Lachhu Maharaj.

Q45. To which of the following states does the dance form Lavani belong?

- A) Tamil Nadu
- B) Madhya Pradesh
- C) Maharashtra**
- D) Assam

Solution: 15.(c) Maharashtra. Indian States and dances: Maharashtra - Dhargari Gaja, Povada dance, Waghya Murali dance, Koli dance. Madhya Pradesh - Bhagoria, Pardhauni, Swang, Matki. Assam - Deva-nati or Natinach, Oja-Pali, Sattriya, Bagurumba. Tamil Nadu - Karakattam, Kummi, Mayil Aattam, Poikkal Kudirai Aattam.

Q46. The "Hornbill Festival" features which indigenous tribes showcasing their culture and traditions ?

- A) Gond
- B) Garo
- C) Naga**
- D) Bhil

Solution: 8.(c) Naga. The Hornbill Festival, also known as the 'Festival of Festivals,' is an annual event celebrated from December 1 to 10 in the northeastern Indian state of Nagaland. This festival was initiated by the Government of Nagaland in 2000. Other festivals in Nagaland include Sekrenyi, Moatsu Mong, Bushu, Yemshe, Metumniu, Metemneo, Ngada, Tokhu Emong, Tuluni, Sukrunye, and Nakhnyulum.

Q47. Padayani is a folk dance from which state ?

- A) Kerala**
- B) Karnataka
- C) Andhra Pradesh
- D) Tamil Nadu

Solution: 15.(a) Kerala. Padayani (Padeni) - A ceremonial dance involving masks, it is an ancient ritual performed in Bhagavati temples. The dance is performed in honor of Bhadrakali. Community - Ganaka. Instrument Used - Thappu (Indian frame drum played with the hands) and Chenda play. Other Traditional Dances of Kerala - Kathakali, Mohiniyattam, Thiruvathirakali, Kolkali, Ottamthullal, chakyar Koothu, Oppana.

Q48. Which sport is the Agha Khan Cup associated with?

- A) Kabaddi
- B) Hockey**
- C) Cricket
- D) Rugby

Solution: 10.(b) Hockey. Sports and Cups/Trophies: Hockey - Beighton Cup, Murugappa Gold Cup, Ranjit Singh Gold Cup, Scindia Gold Cup. Cricket - Irani Trophy, Vijay Merchant Trophy, Cooch Behar Trophy.

Q49. Which musical instrument is played by Pt. Ravi Shankar?

- A) Been
- B) Sarod
- C) Sarangi
- D) Sitar**

Solution: 7.(d) Sitar. Pt. Ravi Shankar received the Bharat Ratna in 1999, the Padma Vibhushan in 1981, the Padma Bhushan in 1967, and the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 1962. Famous sitar players: Wahid Khan, Mushtaq Ali Khan, Nikhil Banerjee, Shamim Ahmed Khan, Shahid Parvez, Budhaditya Mukherjee, Kartick Kumar, and Harvinder Kumar Sharma.

Q50. Who among the following classical dancers was rewarded with the Padma Vibhushan Award in 2003?

- A) Sonal Mansingh**
- B) Kumudini Lakhia
- C) Shovana Narayan
- D) Sunayana Hazarilal

Solution: 13.(a) Sonal Mansingh (Bharatanatyam and Odissi) was awarded the Padma Vibhushan Award in 2003. Awards and honors : Padma Bhushan (1992), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1987), Rajiv Gandhi Excellence Award (1991), Indira Priyadarshini Award (1994), Madhya Pradesh Government's Kalidas Samman (2006). (Shovana Narayan, Kumudini Lakhia and Sunayana Hazar - Kathak).

Q51. Ustad Binda Khan is associated with which of the following instruments?

- A) Shehnai
- B) Tabla
- C) Sarangi**
- D) Flute

Solution: 3.(c) Sarangi. Other exponents of the Sarangi include: Abdul Latif Khan, Ram Narayan, Sultan Khan, and Shakoor Khan. Instruments and Their Notable Exponents: Shehnai - Bismillah Khan, Anant Lal, and Raghunath Prasanna; Tabla - Anindo Chatterjee and Pt. Kishan Maharaj; Flute - Hariprasad Chaurasia, Rajendra Prasanna, and Pannalal Ghosh.

Q52. What is the full form of IADP?

- A) Intensive Agricultural District Programme**
- B) India Agricultural Development Programme
- C) Integrated Agricultural District plan
- D) Intensive Agricultural Development Project

Solution: 11.(a) Intensive Agricultural District Programme (Launched in 1960) - Also known as a "package program"; Aim - To provide loans for seeds and fertilisers to farmers. It was launched in district of 7 states at that time : Thanjavur (Tamil Nadu), West Godavari (Andhra Pradesh), Shahabad (Bihar), Raipur (Madhya Pradesh), Aligarh (Uttar Pradesh), Ludhiana (Punjab), Pali (Rajasthan).

Q53. 77th Independence Day was celebrated in which of the years ?

- A) 2023**
- B) 2021
- C) 2022
- D) 2020

Solution: 1.(a) 2023. 77th Independence Day address on giant strides India has taken in the Electronics and IT Sector. Theme - Nation First, Always First. 'Har Ghar Tiranga' is a campaign under the aegis of Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav to encourage people to bring the Tiranga home and to hoist it to mark the 75th year of India's independence.

Q54. Who among the following composers won the Grammy in 2015 for his album 'Winds of Samsara' - a collaboration with South African flutist Wouter Kellerman?

- A) Mano Murthy
- B) Raghu Dixit
- C) Subhashish Ghosh
- D) Ricky Kej**

Solution: 8.(d) Ricky Kej. Other awards Ricky Kej (music composer and environmentalist) won in 2015 for the same album are ZMR Award for Album of the Year, ZMR Award for Best World Album, and South African Music Award for Best Producer of the Year. He won his second Grammy award in 2022 for his album 'Divine Tides' in category of Best New age album.

Q55. In which state is the Chithirai festival celebrated?

- A) Punjab
- B) Tamil Nadu**
- C) Rajasthan
- D) Meghalaya

Solution: 9.(b) Tamil Nadu. Chithirai Festival - celebrates the celestial union of Lord Sunderswarar (Lord Shiva) and Goddess Meenakshi, considered to be Lord Vishnu's sister. Celebrated in Madurai. Other Festivals - Pongal, Thiruvaiyaru Festival, Thaipusam, Natyanjali Dance Festival, Mahamaham, Tamil New Year's Day, Karthigai Deepam. Punjab - Baisakhi, Hola Mohalla, Lohri, Chappar Mela. Rajasthan - Teej Festival, Momasar Utsav, Pushkar Fair, Desert Festival, Jaisalmer. Meghalaya - Shad Suk Mynsiem, Nongkrem

Festival, Behdienkhlam Festival, Shad Sukra, Wangala Festival.

Q56. Which of the following sites do "Not" have nuclear power plant?

- A) Vijayawada**
- B) Naraura
- C) Tarapur
- D) Rawat Bhata

Solution: 4.(a) Vijayawada. Nuclear power plants in India: Kakrapar Atomic Power Station (1993 , Gujarat), Kalpakkam, Madras (1984 , Tamil Nadu), Narora (1991, Uttar Pradesh), Kaiga (2000 ; Karnataka), Rawatbhata (1973, Rajasthan), Tarapur (1969, Maharashtra), Kudankulam (2013, Tamil Nadu). Under Construction: Chutka (Madhya Pradesh), Gorakhpur (Haryana), Bhimpur (Madhya Pradesh), Mahi Banswara (Rajasthan), Haripur (West Bengal), etc.

Q57. When was 'Vayudoot' airline setup in India?

- A) 1981**
- B) 1991
- C) 1971
- D) 1969

Solution: 6.(a) Vayudoot was a regional airline in India established on 20 January 1981 as a joint-venture between the two state-owned carriers, Indian Airlines and Air India. The airline was headquartered at New Delhi's Safdarjung Airport. It ceased operations on 1 April 1997. Air India (J.R.D Tata , 1932, Mumbai). Kingfisher airlines (Vijay Mallya, 2003, Mumbai, Ceased operations: 20 October 2012).

Q58. How many players are there on a standard ice hockey (when there is no overtime or penalties) team during a game ?

- A) Seven
- B) Six**
- C) Four
- D) Five

Solution: 8.(b) Six. Ice Hockey in India is monitored by the Indian Ice Hockey Association. The India national ice hockey team has been competing at the international level since 2009. Team Games and number of players: Baseball - 9, Basketball - 5, Cricket - 11, Football (Soccer) - 11, Hockey - 11, Kabaddi - 7, Kho Kho - 9, Lacrosse - 10.

Q59. Diwali falls in which of the following months of the Hindu calendar?

- A) Ashadha
- B) Bhadrapada
- C) Jyeshtha
- D) Kartika**

Solution: 7.(d) Kartika. Festivals following Hindu calendar: Chaitra - Ugadi, Gudi Padwa, Ram Navami; Vaishakha - Parashurama Jayanti, Akshaya Tritiya, Mohini Ekadashi; Jyeshtha - Ganga Dussehra; Ashadha - Jagannath Rath Yatra, Guru Purnima; Shavana - Raksha Bandhan, Nag Panchmi; Bhadrapada - Janmashtami, Hartalika Teej, Ganesh Chaturthi; Ashwin - Durga Puja; Kartika - Dhanteras, Diwali, Bhai Dooj, Karwa Chauth.

Q60. Abdul Karim Khan was the exponent of which school of Hindustani Music?

- A) Jaipur Gharana
- B) Gwalior Gharana
- C) Delhi Gharana
- D) Kirana Gharana**

Solution: 9.(d) Abdul Karim Khan was the founder and exponent of the Kirana Gharana school of Hindustani music. He introduced Hindustani Khayal singing and Indian classical music. Gwalior Gharana (oldest gharana; founder: Haddu Khan, Hassu Khan and Nathu Khan). Jaipur gharana (founder: Alladiya Khan). Delhi gharana (founder: Hazrat Ameer Khusro).

Q61. In an Olympics table tennis event, if the points are tied at 10-10, a player then has to strive for a _____ point lead to win the game.

- A) 2**
- B) 3
- C) 1

D) 4

Solution: 5.(a) 2. According to the laws of table tennis, a player can win a game of table tennis by scoring 11 points - with one point awarded for every infringement. Every player gets to serve twice in a row. The first to 11 points is declared the winner. Table tennis rules, the regulations, and equipment used: The game is played on a 2.74 x 1.53-metre rectangular table; The table tennis net stands at a height of 15.25 centimetres; Table tennis racquet - Approximately 17 cm long and 15 cm wide; Table tennis ball - Weighs about 2.7 grams and is spherical with a diameter of 40 millimetres.

Q62. Select the correct sequence of the musical instruments according to the given sequence of their associated personalities : Ustad Allah Rakha, Totaram Sharma, TH Vinayakam.

- A) Tabla, Ghatam, Pakhawaj
- B) Ghatam, Pakhawaj, Tabla
- C) Tabla, Pakhawaj, Ghatam**
- D) Pakhawaj, Tabla, Ghatam

Solution: 8.(c) Tabla, Pakhawaj, Ghatam. Musical Instruments and associated personalities: Tabla - Zakir Hussain, Kishan Maharaj, Jnan Prakash Ghosh. Pakhawaj - Bhavani Shankar, Ayodhya Prasad. Ghatam - E.M. Subramaniam. Flute - Hari Prasad Chaurasia, Pannalal Ghosh, Palladam Sanjiv Rao. Guitar - Braj Bhushan Kabra. Karthal - Gazi Khan Barna. Santoor - Shiv Kumar Sharma, Bhajan Sopori, Tarun Bhattacharya. Sarod - Allauddin Khan, Ali Akbar Khan, Amjad Ali Khan, Tejendra Majumdar.

Q63. Which of the following festivals is celebrated in the month of August-September?

- A) Makar Sankranti
- B) Kite Festival
- C) Bikaner Festival
- D) Onam**

Solution: 10.(d) Onam (Kerala) festival is celebrated in the month of August - September. Makar Sankranti (Punjab), Bikaner festival (Rajasthan) and kite Festival (Gujarat) are celebrated in the month of January. Other Festivals of Kerala:- Thrissur Pooram festival, Boat festival, Attukal Pongala Festival, Vishu, Makaravilakku at Sabarimala Festival, Theyyam Festival.

Q64. Thabal Chongba is a folk dance of which Indian state?

- A) Goa
- B) Mizoram
- C) Manipur**
- D) West Bengal

Solution: 6.(c) Manipur. Folk dances : Goa - Ghode Modni, Dhangar Dance, Goff Talgadi, Shigmo and Mussel khel. Mizoram - Chailam, Cheraw, Khuallam, Bamboo dance. West Bengal - Chhau dance. Manipur - Cheraw dance, Rasa lila, Goura Lila, Pung Cholom.

Q65. Who of the following singer popularized the Sambalpuri folk song 'Rangabati Rangabati' ?

- A) Sunidhi Chauhan
- B) Krishna Patel**
- C) Jonita Gandhi
- D) Vani Jairam

Solution: 4.(b) Krishna Patel. Mitrabhanu Gauntia wrote the Sambalpuri song, which was performed by Jitendra Haripal (Padma Shri, 2017) and Krishna Patel and was produced by Prabhudatta Pradhan. In the middle of the 1970s, the song was initially recorded for All India Radio. Other folk songs - Ghumura Geet, Danda Nacha Geet, Changu Badya, and Dalkahi Geet.

Q66. Ustad Asad Ali Khan played which of the following instruments?

- A) Rudra Veena**
- B) Algoza
- C) Sitar
- D) Ravanahatha

Solution: 11.(a) Rudra Veena (plucked string instrument). Asad Ali Khan (Awards): Padma Bhushan (2008), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1977). Instrument and Artist: Sitar (stringed instrument) - Ravi Shankar, Nikhil Banerjee, Anoushka Shankar, Vilayat Khan. Algoza (paired woodwind

instrument) - Misri Khan Jamali, Taga Ram Bheel. Rudra Veena - Asit Kumar Banerjee, Bahauddin Dagar, Jyoti Hegde, Suvir Misra. Ravanahatha (an ancient bowed, stringed instrument) - Dinesh Subasinghe.

Q67. Pushkar Camel fair is associated with which of the following states ?

- A) Rajasthan**
- B) Maharashtra
- C) Gujarat
- D) Punjab

Solution: 14.(a) Rajasthan. The Pushkar Fair (Pushkar Camel Fair) or Pushkar Mela, is an annual weeklong camel and livestock fair held in the town of Pushkar between the months of October and November. Famous Fairs in Indian States: Rajasthan - Desert Festivals, Baneshwar fair. Bihar - Sonepur Fair. Assam - Ambubachi Mela. and Haryana - Surajkund Mela.

Q68. Gaan-Ngai is a five-day festival primarily celebrated in which part of India ?

- A) Northern
- B) North-Eastern**
- C) Western
- D) Southern

Solution: 14.(b) North-Eastern. The Gaan Ngai festival is celebrated after the harvest. Observed By - The Zeliangrong people. States where it is mainly Celebrated - Assam, Manipur, Nagaland. Other North-Eastern Festivals - Bihu (Assam), Moatsu Mong (Nagaland), Ambubachi Mela (Assam), Losar Festival (Arunachal Pradesh). Harvest Festivals in India : Makar Sakranti - Haryana, Delhi. Lohri - Punjab, Haryana. Onam - Kerala. Pongal - Tamil Nadu. Uttarayan - Gujarat. Poush Sankranti - West Bengal.

Q69. How many points are there in the 4th set in volleyball?

- A) 15
- B) 16
- C) 25**
- D) 8

Solution: 1.(c) 25. Volleyball: Number of players - 6, Court - 18 meters long and 9 wide. The net is 2.43 meters high for men's games and 2.24 meters high for women's games. Other games: Tennis - The first point is "15". The second is "30. The third point is "40". Badminton: The best of 3 games of 21 points. Terminologies (Volleyball) :- block, decoy, dig, dump, pancake, tandem, Stuff etc.

Q70. Since 2004, which of the following states in India is the permanent venue of International Film Festival of India?

- A) Gujarat
- B) New Delhi
- C) Goa**
- D) Maharashtra

Solution: 7.(c) Goa. International Film Festival of India, founded in 1952. The first IFFI was held in 1952 in Bombay, and it has been held in Goa since 2004. The festival is held annually with the aim of providing a common platform for cinemas across the world to project excellence of film art. Some most notable films that have won the Golden Peacock Award at IFFI - Aakrosh (1981), Karunam (2000), Moner Manush (2010), Anhe Ghore Da Daan (2012).

Q71. Jayalakshmi Eshwar won the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award 2021 for her contribution to which Indian classical dance form ?

- A) Bharatanatyam**

- B) Kathakali
- C) Kathak
- D) Odissi

Solution: 13.(a) Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu). Famous Dancers - Bala Saraswati, Rukmini Devi Arundale, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Padma Subrahmanyam, Mallika Sarabhai, Alarmed Valli. Famous Kathakali Dancer - Kalamandalam Gopi, Kalamandalam Krishna Prasad, Kottakal Sivaraman, Kalamandalam Ramankutty Nair. Famous Kathak dancers - Pandit Birju Maharaj, Lachu Maharaj, Kumari Kamala. Famous Odissi Dancer - Aadya Kaktikar, Shreelina Ghosh, Sonal Mansingh.

Q72. Tulip Festival is famous in which city ?

- A) Agra
- B) Allahabad
- C) Ludhiana
- D) Srinagar**

Solution: 8.(d) Srinagar. Tulip Festival in Kashmir is celebrated annually to display the vast range of flowers at the Indira Gandhi Memorial Tulip Garden in Srinagar. It is organized during the onset of spring season in Kashmir valley. Other Flower Festivals in India: Rose Festival (Chandigarh), Ooty Flower Show (Tamil Nadu), International Flower Festival (Gangtok, Sikkim), Lalbagh Flower Show (Bangalore), Dasara Flower Show (Mysore), Cherry Blossom Festival (Shillong, Meghalaya).

Q73. To which of the following states does the folk dance Khorja belong ?

- A) Maharashtra
- B) Haryana**
- C) Assam
- D) West Bengal

Solution: 10.(b) Haryana. The Khorja dance is performed exclusively by women at weddings and festivals. States and their folk dances: Haryana - Phaag, Saang, Chhathi, Dhamal, Gugga. Assam - Bihu, Bagurumba, Bhortal. Maharashtra - Lavani, Gondhal, Koli, Tamasha. West Bengal - Baul dance, Fakir, Brita.

Q74. Which Indian dancer won the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 2018 for Chhau Dance ?

- A) Akham Lakshmi Devi
- B) Tapan kumar pattanayak**
- C) Dr. Aruna Mohanty
- D) Gopika Varma

Solution: 11.(b) Tapan Kumar Pattanayak (Seraikella). Chhau is performed in three styles: Purulia Chhau (West Bengal), Seraikella Chhau (Jharkhand), and Mayurbhanj Chhau (Odisha). Notable Chhau dancers include Kedar Nath Sahoo (Seraikella), Shashadhar Acharya, and Gambhir Singh Mura (Purulia).

Q75. Kapil Dev lifted the 1983 World Cup (then known as the Prudential Cup '83) in the _____ stadium

- A) Lord's**
- B) Eden Gardens
- C) Holkar
- D) Green Park

Solution: 13.(a) Lord's, England. The final of the 1983 Cricket World Cup was played between India and the West Indies. Men's Cricket World Cup Finals: 1975 (Winner: West Indies) - Lord's, England. 1992 (Pakistan) - MCG, Melbourne. 2011 (India) - Wankhede Stadium, Mumbai. 2023 (Australia) - Narendra Modi Stadium, Ahmedabad.